Post-Game Reflection

The what-happened sheet

The moments right after a game are the cheapest lessons you will ever get — the position is still fresh, and your memory of the turning point is still reliable. Ten honest minutes on this sheet turns a game into a plan. Fill it in before you analyze with a computer, not after.

How to use it

1. **Cool down first, then write.** A sip of water, a short walk. Feelings cool, facts stay.
2. **Name what decided it.** The two "turning point" boxes are for the move (or moves) where the game swung — write the move number if you still remember it.
3. **Be kind on purpose.** "Got outplayed" is allowed. "Lost it over the board" is also allowed. What is not useful is deciding you are bad at chess because of one hour.
4. **Pick exactly one drill for next time.** One thing, written down, gets done. Five things get abandoned.
5. **Keep every sheet.** Three months of them shows you the pattern no single game can — and the pattern is usually one specific weakness, not "everything."

Pencils only. This sheet is for how the game felt while it was still true — erasing and revising after engine analysis is missing the point. Write, reflect, move on.

Beginner tip: The strongest players lose about as often as anyone at your level — the difference is what they feed back into training. A reflection sheet is how you score your own game instead of just the result.

Post-Game Reflection

Date: _____ Time control: _____ I played: ☐ White ☐ Black

Result: ☐ win ☐ draw ☐ loss Opponent felt: ☐ stronger ☐ similar ☐ weaker

The game in one sentence _____

Turning point #1: _____

Turning point #2 (if there was one):

In my view, the game was decided by:

☐ an opening surprise ☐ a missed tactic ☐ a hanging piece
☐ clock trouble ☐ endgame technique ☐ a mating attack
☐ nerves / focus ☐ just got outplayed, no shame ☐ other: _____

Clock report — when the game was decided: **my clock** _____ **theirs** _____

Did I get into time trouble? ☐ **no** ☐ **yes, recoverable** ☐ **yes, it cost me**

One thing I'm proud of:

One drill I'll do before my next game:

How I feel about my chess this game: ☐ **1** ☐ **2** ☐ **3** ☐ **4** ☐ **5** **(1 = brutal, 5 = proud)**

Pencils only — no pens near the board. One sheet per game, filed behind its scoresheet.